

Dental Health and Career Evidence Guide

NAME _____ DATE _____ PERIOD _____

Read the label before you compare

The pay figures are **May 2024 U.S. medians from BLS**. A median is the middle wage. These are not starting pay and are not DFW-localized. Outlook is the projected U.S. employment change from 2024-34.

CAREER	COMMON PREPARATION	U.S. MEDIAN	OUTLOOK	ONE COMMON RESPONSIBILITY
Dental Assistant	Postsecondary nondegree award is typical; requirements vary by state	\$47,300	6%	Prepare patients, assist with procedures, records, or X-rays when qualified
Dental Hygienist	Associate degree is typical; programs often take about 3 years; state license	\$94,260	7%	Clean teeth, assess oral health, and teach prevention
Medical Records Specialist	Postsecondary nondegree award is typical	\$50,250	7%	Review, classify, and enter health information; some assign clinical codes

Do not mix measures. If Xello shows a local figure, record the geography, date, and type of pay before comparing it.

Course evidence rule

This is a classroom comparison rule, not an official government label.

- **High-wage evidence:** May 2024 U.S. median is above the same-source all-occupation median of **\$49,500**.
- **High-demand evidence:** projected growth is above the same-source all-occupation rate of **3%**.
- **High-skill evidence:** the source shows specialized preparation, licensure/credential, or specialized duties.

Use evidence without overclaiming

- “The median is \$94,260” does not mean every worker earns that amount.
- “Postsecondary nondegree award” does not guarantee the same program length everywhere.
- Growth above 3% is evidence for this class comparison; it does not prove every local employer is hiring.
- A career page describes a common route. Students should verify current Texas and program requirements before enrolling.

Current Irving connection

The current Irving ISD Singley Academy page lists **Dental** in the School of Health Science. The older workbook also discusses Medical Billing and Coding, but the current public page does not verify it as a Singley program. Treat Medical Records Specialist as career exploration unless the district confirms a current program.

Sources checked August 6, 2026

- U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics Occupational Outlook Handbook: Dental Assistants; Dental Hygienists; Medical Records Specialists
- BLS Occupational Employment and Wage Statistics: May 2024 all-occupation median
- Irving ISD: Singley Academy CTE pathways